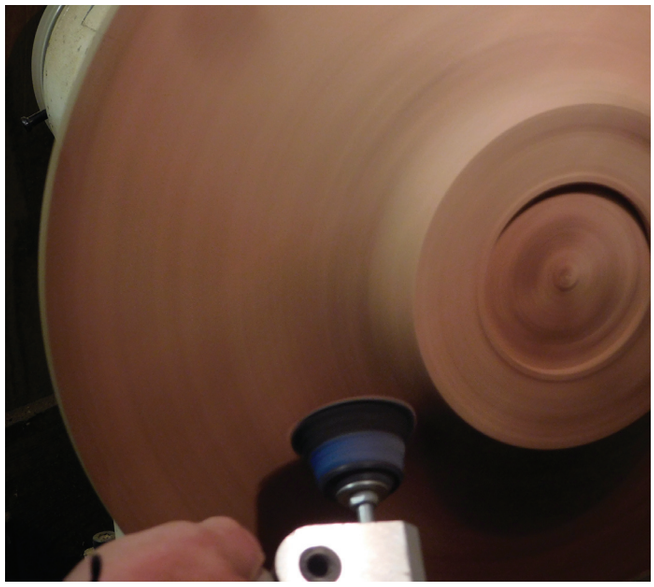

Abrading with an arbor

Blow out the dust from abrading

Remounting the bowl

Ensure your hold is good when remounting the bowl. If you have any irregular edges on the recess, try to position it so that you have maximum and safe hold. If you have the least doubt, stop and reconsider your mounting option.

During turning the outside of the bowl, I found I was able to remove the 'step' in its entirety. As a result, I was able to make the bowl section larger than anticipated. The edge of the bowl however, presented a common problem exhibited in burr; the bark inclusions were deeper than anticipated and it was obvious that for safety and aesthetic considerations that I needed to remove the bark. With the lathe switched off it can be picked out with an awl or craft knife, cleaning the edges as you go.

Bowl secured in recess

Setting rim thickness

Turning the inside and personalisation

I had wanted to make the bowl in Phil's style, but couldn't resist a little colour and detail to give it a hint of my own. A pair of beads and some black stain were enough to achieve this. Turning the beads, one at the intersection of the rim and bowl, and one on the periphery of the rim, can be tricky with irregular edges and surfaces: your tools need to be sharp, the cuts light, and your attention constant. As with any wood with voids, too much pressure in the cut and the tool may pass in to the void causing a catch.

The bowl section of a burr bowl is often the easiest area to turn. As in the case here, the bowl is to be cut from the thickest section of wood roughly in the centre of the blank, away from the bark inclusions, towards the edges, but there remains an area of potential problems: the base of the bowl. As you move towards the base of the bowl the wall gets ever closer to the outer wall, where the majority of the bark inclusions were to be found. This can make the walls weak and the potential for a break-through, or worse still a blow-out, is ever present, so extreme care should be taken.

Cutting a sweeping surface is usually as good as it gets with burr, but if you do have problems, then a scraper might be the answer. The lack of any distinct grain direction means the wood cuts like a dense exotic, or for that matter like a block of acrylic, and the wire edge on a scraper works beautifully here.

I sealed the bowl with cellulose sealer, applied with a brush, and oil applied in the same manner.

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